LISTEN · LEARN · SPEAK

Why You Forget Names So Quickly

Three surprising reasons names slip away, simple tricks to remember them, polite English for when you forget – and Jack's eight-month neighbour mystery.



Name: _____

Date: _____

My score: _____ / 100 ⭐

★ How to use this worksheet

1 · Before you listen 🧠
Do the warm-up and learn the key words. Questions with 🧠 can be answered before listening.

2 · While you listen 🎧
Answer the 🎧 questions. The ⏱ times show where to find each part of the video.

3 · After you listen 💬
Play the memory game, solve the word search and share your name disaster in the comments!

0 Warm-up: Name disaster check

fun · no points

Be honest! Tick everything that has happened to you. 🙈

- ☐ 😳 I've called someone by the wrong name.
- ☐ 💨 I forgot a name seconds after I heard it.
- ☐ 🐱 I know someone's pet's name, but not theirs!
- ☐ 🙈 I avoided someone because I forgot their name.

Guess! Which is easier to remember about a new person?

(a) "He's a baker." (b) "His name is Mr Baker." (c) the same

🎧 **Check your guess at ⏱ 2:37**

Lucy: "At a wedding, I said, 'It was so nice to meet you, Rachel!' Her name was Helen." 😬



💬 Let's talk

Say your answers out loud – or write them in your notebook.

1. Are you better with names or with faces?

2. Does your name have a short version or a nickname?

3. Do people ever say or spell your name wrong?

4. What do you usually do when you forget someone's name?

1 Key words

vocabulary · 10 points

Match each word or phrase (1–10) to its meaning (a–j). Write the letter in the box. 🧠 Check in the Word Tour at ⏱️ 15:14

1. ☐ **1.** to recall
2. ☐ **2.** to mix up
3. ☐ **3.** on the tip of my tongue
4. ☐ **4.** to ring a bell
5. ☐ **5.** to introduce
6. ☐ **6.** memorable
7. ☐ **7.** to catch (a name)
8. ☐ **8.** embarrassing
9. ☐ **9.** a nickname
10. ☐ **10.** a colleague

a) to seem familiar, but you're not completely sure
b) a person you work with
c) to hear something clearly
d) to bring something back into your mind
e) easy to remember, because it's special or unusual
f) a short or friendly name, like Bob or Liz
g) to confuse two people or things
h) making you feel silly or uncomfortable
i) you know it, but you can't say it right now
j) to tell people each other's names when they first meet



Pronunciation corner 🔊 **COL**-league · **NEIGH**-bour (the "gh" is silent!) · **MEM**-o-ra-ble · in-tro-**DUCE** · em-**BAR**-rass-ing. Say it out loud: *"Sorry, it's on the tip of my tongue!"*

2 First listen: the big idea

listening · 2 points

Watch the whole episode once without stopping. Which sentence is the **main message**? 🎧

- (a) Forgetting names is normal – and simple tricks and polite phrases can help.
- (b) People forget names because they don't care about other people.
- (c) If you forget a name, it's always too late to ask again.



Jack's tip: First listen = the **big picture**. Don't stop the video and don't worry about every word. Second listen = the **details**. That's when you answer the 🎧 questions.

🔮 **Predict before you listen!** (no points) Seven of these words are in the episode. One is **not**. Circle the one you think you **won't** hear – then check while you listen.

wedding · **cake** · **flour** · **sailors** · **bike** · **passport** · **stairs** · **cat basket**

3 Know it or hear it?

quiz + listening · 10 points

Circle a, b or c. Questions 🧠 1–5: you can probably answer them **before** you listen. Questions 🎧 6–10: listen to find the answer.



🧠 YOU MIGHT ALREADY KNOW

1. "It's on the tip of my tongue" means…

(a) I said it too quickly
(b) I almost remember it
(c) it tastes strange

🧠 Look at Exercise 1

2. "Sorry, what _____ your name again?"

(a) was
(b) were
(c) be

🧠 Grammar you know

3. To "mix up" two people means to…

(a) introduce them
(b) take a photo of them
(c) confuse them

🧠 Look at Exercise 1

4. You didn't hear a name. The most polite reply is…

(a) "Say again your name."
(b) "Sorry, I didn't catch your name."
(c) "What?"

🧠 Think about it

5. "Have you two met?" is a question we use to…

(a) introduce two people
(b) say goodbye
(c) ask for directions

🧠 Common sense

🎉 **How many did you know?**
Now press play and test your ears!

🎧 LISTEN AND FIND OUT

6. What name did Lucy call the bride's cousin?

(a) Helen
(b) Claire
(c) Rachel

🎧 ⏱️ 0:05

7. People remembered the word better when "Baker" was…

(a) the man's job
(b) the man's name
(c) the man's town

🎧 ⏱️ 2:37

8. With the next-in-line effect, we don't store what we hear just before…

(a) we go to sleep
(b) our own turn to speak
(c) we eat lunch

🎧 ⏱️ 5:25

9. Lucy's first tip: when someone tells you their name…

(a) write it on your hand
(b) ask for their phone number
(c) say it back immediately

🎧 ⏱️ 7:38

10. For eight months, Claire called Jack…

(a) "the man with the bike"
(b) "the man with the cat"
(c) "the man next door"

🎧 ⏱️ 19:37

🧩 **Fun fact:** In the 1973 study, people forgot what they heard in the **9 seconds** before their own turn to speak.

4 Three reasons we forget names

think + listen · 6 points



Read about the three reasons. Then write **A**, **B** or **C** next to each sentence (1–6). 🎧 ⏱️ 2:37 · 5:25 · 6:46

A · Baker-baker paradox 🥖
A job makes lots of connections in your brain. A name is just a sound – it has **no hooks**.
Fix: give the name a hook.

B · The next-in-line effect 🙋
You're busy preparing what **you** will say, so the name never really arrives.
Fix: listen, then say it back.

C · The forgetting curve 📉
We forget new information **very quickly**, especially in the first hours.
Fix: write it down later.

1	"I was thinking about what to say, so I didn't really hear her name."	☐
2	"I remember he's a nurse with two dogs, but not his name."	☐
3	"I knew her name at lunchtime, but by the evening it was gone."	☐
4	"I was worried about my sweaty hand when he said, 'Hi, I'm Daniel.'"	☐
5	"I heard his name once and never used it again."	☐
6	"A name like 'Smith' doesn't connect to anything I know about her."	☐

5 True or false?

listening · 6 points

Listen and circle **T** (true) or **F** (false). The ⏱️ times help you find the answer.

1	Lucy talked to the bride's cousin for about twenty minutes.	T	F	⏱️ 0:05
2	Jack doesn't know the name of his neighbour's cat.	T	F	⏱️ 4:15
3	When people were told to pay attention before their turn, the problem disappeared.	T	F	⏱️ 5:25
4	Ebbinghaus found that we forget new information slowly, over many years.	T	F	⏱️ 6:46
5	In many English-speaking workplaces, people use first names quickly – even with the boss.	T	F	⏱️ 10:03
6	In the end, Jack asked Claire for her name directly.	T	F	⏱️ 19:37

🧠 Memory game – part A (the test is on page 7!)



You're at a party. Meet six people. Read each name and **see the hook in your mind** for 1 minute. Then cover this box!

👩‍🦰 Rose	👨‍🦱 Mark	👵 Daisy	🧔 Bill	👱‍♀️ Sunny	👱‍♂️ Robin
a big red rose 🌹 behind her ear	draws a mark ✏️ on his forehead	a daisy 🌼 in her hat	a duck's bill 🦆 – that's its mouth!	always smiling, like the sun ☀️	a robin 🐦 sits on his head

6 "What was your name again?" listening 10 points



Two new colleagues meet again in their first week. Listen at ⏱️ 13:21 and write **one word** in each gap (1–8). Then answer A and B. The breakdown at ⏱️ 14:27 can help.



LUCY
Hi, we met on 1 _____, didn't we? In the kitchen?

JACK
Yes! Hi! Sorry, this is so 2 _____, but I'm terrible with names. What was your name 3 _____?





LUCY
Don't worry, it happens to everyone! It's Priya.

JACK
Priya. That's a lovely name. Is it P-R-I-Y-A?





LUCY
Exactly. And you're Jack, right?

JACK
That's right. Wow, you remembered. Now I feel even 4 _____.





LUCY
Don't. I only remembered because you told me you'd just moved here from the 5 _____, and I thought of jacks on a ship. You know, sailors.

JACK
That's a great 6 _____. So, Priya, how are you 7 _____ the job so far?





LUCY
Good, but there are so many new faces. My head's 8 _____.

JACK
Same here. Hey, maybe we should make a list together.





LUCY
Good idea. We can help each other out.

A. Which little **question tag** makes Lucy's first line friendly?

_____

B. Find the phrase that means **"support each other"**:

_____

🎭 **Say it out loud!** Play both parts – and use **your own name** instead of Jack's.

7 What would you say? polite phrases 6 points

Circle the best thing to say in each situation. 🎧 Help at ⏱️ 12:20



1. It's noisy and you didn't hear a new person's name.	(a) Sorry, I didn't catch your name. (b) Sorry, I mixed you up. (c) Have you two met?
2. You met someone this morning. Now it's 4 p.m. and you can't remember her name.	(a) What is your name? (b) Sorry, what was your name again? (c) Nice to meet you!
3. You know the name... you can almost say it... but it won't come out!	(a) It rings a bell. (b) I'm terrible at names. (c) It's on the tip of my tongue.
4. Your friend Tom and your colleague Maria meet for the first time.	(a) Tom, this is my colleague Maria. (b) Maria is she my colleague. (c) Remember Maria!
5. A new colleague always says your name wrong.	(a) Say nothing for years. (b) That's wrong! (c) Actually, it's pronounced... But don't worry, everyone gets it wrong at first.
6. You're not sure how to say someone's name.	(a) Avoid using it. (b) Am I saying that right? (c) Can I call you Bob?



Jack's tip – don't wait! The word **"again"** shows you know they told you before. And ask quickly: on day two, it's nothing. After eight months... it's very hard! 😬

8 Spell it out! 🔤 new! pronunciation 6 points

"Is it P-R-I-Y-A?" To spell names, you need the **names of the letters**. Letters in the same box share the same vowel sound.

A H J K /eɪ/ – d**ay**	**B C D E G P T V** /iː/ – s**ee**	**F L M N S X Z** /e/ – r**ed**	**I Y** /aɪ/ – m**y**	**O** /əʊ/ – g**o**	**Q U W** /uː/ – y**ou**	**R** /ɑː/ – c**ar**

Z is "zed" in British English and "zee" in American English. Both are correct!

Odd one out: circle the letter with a **different** vowel sound.

1. (A) (J) (E) (K)	2. (B) (F) (P) (G)	3. (M) (N) (L) (I)
4. (Q) (O) (U) (W)	5. (C) (D) (Y) (T)	6. (S) (X) (F) (R)

🗣️ **Your turn** (no points): Spell these names out loud: **PRIYA · CLAIRE · HELEN · YUSUF** – and then **your own name**. Which letters are tricky for you?

9 Memory game – part B: Who's who?

new! memory hooks · 6 points



Remember the party on page 4? **Don't look back!** Write each person's name. Think of the hook first. 🪝

1	2	3	4	5	6
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

💡 Did the hooks help? That's the Baker trick: you turned **Mr Baker** into **a baker**!

10 Short names

culture · 4 points

Many English names have a short version. Match the names (1–4) to their short forms (a–d). ⏱️ 10:03

- ☐ **1.** Robert
- ☐ **2.** Elizabeth
- ☐ **3.** David
- ☐ **4.** William

a) Dave · **b) Liz** · **c) Bill** · **d) Bob**

😄 So if a colleague says **"Call me Dave"**, it's a friendly invitation – not a test!

11 Say it better

common mistakes · 10 points

These sentences sound unnatural. Write a more natural version (2 points each). ⏱️ 17:38

😐 1. "I don't remember your name, what is your name?" 😊 _____

😐 2. "I didn't hear your name good." 😊 _____

😐 3. "My memory for names is very bad." 😊 _____

😐 4. "I confused your name with another person." 😊 _____

😐 5. "This is Maria, she is my friend, Maria this is Tom." 😊 _____



Lucy's tip: "I'm terrible with names" is a little honest joke about yourself. It works because almost everyone feels the same. The answer is often: *"Oh, me too!"* 😄



Share it with us! Tell us your best **name disaster** in the comments – and one name you remember perfectly, and the trick that helped you. 💜

12 Clue word search + secret message

puzzle · 10 points



Step 1: Complete each clue – the first letter and the number of letters are given (1 point each). **Step 2:** Find the 10 words in the grid. They go → ↓ ↘ or ↗ and never cross each other.

1. Lucy couldn't **r**_____ Helen's name at the wedding.
2. She has a very **m**_____ laugh – it's easy to remember.
3. "Let me **i**_____ you to my sister."
4. People remember "he's a **b**_____" better than "his name is Mr Baker".
5. For eight months, Jack didn't know his **n**_____'s name.
6. "Bob" is a **n**_____ for Robert.
7. Priya is Jack's new **c**_____ at work.
8. Lucy called Helen "Rachel" at a **w**_____.
9. Jack always knew the cat's name: **b**_____!
10. Helen was the bride's **c**_____.

S	B	O	B	A	K	E	R	E	R	R
M	R	I	Y	I	M	T	C	N	E	E
R	E	R	S	I	B	U	L	I	M	C
E	W	M	I	C	D	T	G	C	E	O
H	N	A	O	O	U	N	M	K	M	L
E	S	W	R	R	I	I	H	N	B	L
A	T	T	W	D	A	A	T	A	E	E
S	N	Y	D	O	U	B	R	M	R	A
I	N	E	A	M	E	A	L	E	G	G
A	W	C	O	U	S	I	N	E	I	U
N	N	E	I	G	H	B	O	U	R	E

🤫 **Step 3 – the secret message** (no points) Cross out the 10 words. Then write the letters that are left, row by row, from left to right. You'll find two very useful sentences!

_____, __'__ _____ _____ _____. _____

_____ _____ _____ _____?

13 Jack's neighbour mystery

listening · 6 points



Listen at ⏱️ 19:37. Put the events in the right order. Write 1–6 in the boxes.

- ☐ 🪜 On the stairs, Jack said, "Have you two met? This is my friend Sam."
- ☐ 🙂 For eight months, they just smiled and said "Hi!"
- ☐ 🤝 She shook Sam's hand and said, "Hi, I'm Claire."
- ☐ 🏠 On the first day, she told Jack her name – and he forgot it.
- ☐ 😂 The next day, Jack told Claire the truth. She laughed.
- ☐ 🚪 Jack's friend Sam came to visit.

Think about it 💭 (no points) What was the funny surprise at the end of the story?



14 Your turn

writing · 8 points

Write two sentences in each box (2 points for each good sentence).

A. Give your name a hook 🪝

Help people remember you! *e.g. "I'm Thiago. It's like Diego, but with a T." · "I'm Yusuf, but most people call me Joe."*

B. My name disaster 🙈

Use **mix up**, **on the tip of my tongue** or **embarrassing**. *e.g. "Once, I mixed up two colleagues…"*

My name collector

your 7-day mission

Every time you meet someone new this week: say their name back, give it a hook – and write it here before it disappears! (That's how you beat the forgetting curve.)

Day	Name	Hook or note (e.g. Daniel – accounts – loves cycling 🚲)	Said it back?
1			☐
2			☐
3			☐
4			☐
5			☐
6			☐
7			☐

✂️ Cut out and keep in your pocket

🙈 DIDN'T HEAR
Sorry, I didn't catch your name.
Could you tell me your name again?

🤔 FORGOT
Sorry, what was your name again?
Remind me of your name?

😅 BE HONEST
I'm terrible with names, sorry!
I mixed you up with someone else.

🤝 INTRODUCE
Have you two met?
Tom, this is my friend Maria.

Can you do it now?

I can…	Not yet	Almost	Yes!
explain three reasons why we forget names.	😟	🙂	😄
ask politely when I didn't catch or forgot a name.	😟	🙂	😄
spell my name clearly with English letter names.	😟	🙂	😄
introduce two people: "Have you two met?"	😟	🙂	😄

Answer key

Count your points and write your score on page 1!

0 · Warm-up & predict

Guess: a – a job is easier to remember than the same word as a name. · Predict: **passport** 🛂 isn't in the episode.

1 · Key words · 2 · The big idea

1 d · 2 g · 3 i · 4 a · 5 j · 6 e · 7 c · 8 h · 9 f · 10 b
Big idea: a (2 points)

3 · Know it or hear it?

1 b · 2 a · 3 c · 4 b · 5 a · 6 c · 7 a · 8 b · 9 c · 10 a

4 · Three reasons we forget names

1 B · 2 A · 3 C · 4 B · 5 C · 6 A

5 · True or false?

1 T · 2 F (her name is Biscuit) · 3 T · 4 F (we forget quickly, especially in the first hours) · 5 T · 6 F (he introduced his friend Sam)

6 · "What was your name again?"

1 Monday · 2 embarrassing · 3 again · 4 worse · 5 coast · 6 trick · 7 finding · 8 spinning · A didn't we · B help each other out

7 · What would you say?

1 a · 2 b · 3 c · 4 a · 5 c · 6 b

8 · Spell it out!

1 E (/iː/) · 2 F (/e/) · 3 I (/aɪ/) · 4 O (/əʊ/) · 5 Y (/aɪ/) · 6 R (/ɑː/)

9 · Who's who? · 10 · Short names

9: 1 Sunny · 2 Rose · 3 Robin · 4 Daisy · 5 Mark · 6 Bill
10: 1 d (Bob) · 2 b (Liz) · 3 a (Dave) · 4 c (Bill)

11 · Say it better (2 points each)

1 Sorry, what was your name again? / Remind me of your name? · 2 Sorry, I didn't catch your name. · 3 I'm terrible (hopeless) with names. · 4 Sorry, I mixed you up with someone else. · 5 Tom, this is my friend Maria. Maria, this is Tom. / Have you two met?

12 · Word search (1 point per word)

1 remember · 2 memorable · 3 introduce · 4 baker · 5 neighbour · 6 nickname · 7 colleague · 8 wedding · 9 biscuit · 10 cousin
Secret: Sorry, I'm terrible with names. What was your name again?



13 · Neighbour mystery · 14 · Your turn

1 🏠 first day · 2 🙂 eight months · 3 🚪 Sam visits · 4 🪜 "Have you two met?" · 5 🤝 "I'm Claire." · 6 😂 the truth
Surprise: Claire didn't know Jack's name either!
14: your own answers – 2 points per good sentence.

90–100 🏆	70–89 🪝	50–69 🔔	0–49 👅
Name master!	Hook pro	It rings a bell	On the tip of your tongue – listen again!

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